

Wei(Rocio) Zhong

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Stony Brook University	wei.zhong.1@stonybrook.edu https://rociozhong.github.io
ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Stony Brook University , Stony Brook, NY Department of Political Science Assistant Professor, Sep 2025 – Present New York University , New York, NY Center for Social Media and Politics Postdoctoral Research Scientist, Sep 2023 – Aug 2025 George Washington University , Washington, DC Institute for Data, Democracy & Politics, School of Engineering and Applied Science Research Scientist, Feb 2021 – Aug 2023	
EDUCATION	University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign , Urbana, IL Ph.D., Political Science, Aug 2021 Dissertation: “Candidates, the Economy and Voting Behavior” M.S., Statistics, May 2018 New York University , New York, NY M.A., Politics, May 2014 University of International Business and Economics , Beijing, China B.A., Spanish, Jun 2009	
RESEARCH INTEREST	Comparative Politics, Political Methodology Online Hate and Extremism, Polarization, Social Media, Computational Methods	
PUBLICATIONS	Zhong, W. , & Broniatowski, D.A. (2023). Economic risk framing increases intention to vaccinate among Republican COVID-19 vaccine refusers. <i>Social Science & Medicine</i> , 317, 115594. Bailard, C., Tromble, R., Zhong, W. , Bianchi, F., Hosseini, P., & Broniatowski, D.A. (2024). “Keep Your Heads Held High Boys!”: Examining the Relationship between the Proud Boys’ Online Discourse and Offline Activities. <i>American Political Science Review</i> , 1–18. Zhong, W. , Bailard, C., Broniatowski, D., & Tromble, R. (2024). Proud Boys on Telegram. <i>Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media</i> , 4, 1–47. Zhong, W. , & Zhang, M. (2025). Subdued but Unbroken: The Cohesion of Far-Right Extremist Followers after Deplatforming. <i>Perspectives on Politics</i> , 1-26. Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Brown, M., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., Zhong, W. , Dahlke, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. <i>Social Media+ Society</i> , 11(2). Zhong, W. , Chen, B., Liang, F. & Zhang, M. (2025). Picturing Protest: A Deep Dive into the Visual Representation of Protests in Authoritarian Countries’ Media on Twitter. <i>Digital Journalism</i> , 1-22 Broniatowski, D., Zhong, W. , W., Simons, J.R., Jamison, A.M., Dredze, M., & Abrams, L.C. (2025). Explaining Twitter’s inability to effectively moderate content during the COVID-19 pandemic. <i>Scientific Reports</i> , 15(1), 36096. Lukito, J., Pruden, M. L., Suk, J., Yang, Y., & Zhong, W. (2026). Political Communication Special Issue Introduction: Multi-Platform Research. <i>Political Communication</i> , 43(2), 175–191.	

UNDER REVIEW	Suk, J.*, Zhong, W.* , Zhang, Y., Pruden M., Yang, Y., Mao, C., & DiFranzo D. Unveiling Engagement and Platform Algorithmic Biases in Social Media Data Collection and Analysis: An Experimental Study. [*co-first author]	
	Zhong, W. From Policy to Personality: How Americans Evaluate Presidential Candidates, 1984–2020.	
	Zhong, W.* , Sanderson, Z.*, & Tucker, J.A. It Works When It Works: Measuring the Direct and Indirect Effects of AI Labels on Political Images. [*co-first author]	
	Zhong, W. , Tan, H., Wang, B., & Zhang, K. Self-reinforcing media antagonism sustains U.S.-China rivalry	
SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS	Zhong, W. , Zhang, Y., & Xu, Y. Territorial Contraction: Far-Right Mobilization and Everyday Public Life in American Neighborhoods	
	Bisbee J, & Zhong, W. WLM Telegram: Images and Text	
	Zhong, W. , Much, M., Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Tweets and Beliefs: Online Political Environments and Immigration Attitudes	
	Zhong, W. , & Nagler, J. Opinion Change and Voter Learning across Political Issues in U.S. Elections.	
SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Zhong, W. , Xu, X., & Chen, H. The Rise and Contestation of Identity in Global Media	
	Barrie, C., Zhang, M., Zhong, W. , Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Social Media and Cross-Cutting Conversations	
	US 2020 Presidential Election Researcher	Dec 2021 - Sep 2023
	META (formerly Facebook) Menlo Park, CA	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Data Science Research Intern	May 2019 - Aug 2019
	DiDi AI LABS Beijing, China	
	Instructor	
	POL 201 Introduction to Statistical Methods in Political Science, SBU	Spring 2026
LANGUAGES	POL 604 Quantitative Analysis III (Graduate), SBU	Fall 2025
	PS 385 Politics of the European Union (Online), UIUC	Spring 2020
	PS 241 Comparative Politics in Developing Nations (Online), UIUC	Fall 2019, Spring 2018
	Teaching Assistant	
SOFTWARE	Quantitative Analysis I, II, III (Graduate), UIUC	2018–2019
	Introduction to Political Research, UIUC	Spring 2017
	Introduction to International Relations, UIUC	Spring 2016
	English(fluent), Chinese(native), Spanish(proficient)	
SERVICES	Python, R, SQL, LATEX, Git, ArcGIS	
	Manuscript Referee	
	American Political Science Review, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Journal of Experimental Political Science, PNAS Nexus, Nature Communications	
	Guest Editor	
	Special Issue on Multi-Platform Research for <i>Political Communication</i>	